CA Office Manager - Release notes

Version 1.1.0 - 30 October 2026

Status: still under testing. 211 backend tests and 82 browser tests pass against a simulated Google environment; the shared-code route was proven on a live Techmin workspace.

- **Mandatory automatic backup on a day chosen by the firm administrator**, JSON download and restore with a safety copy, and an alert to administrators when a backup is missed.
- **Updates without pasting code.** Shared Techmin library, an *update available* banner and automatic database upgrade at first sign-in.
- **Faster.** One request at sign-in, 20-second read cache, batched writes, cached Users and Settings, an append-only audit log write, and a progress bar while waiting for Google.
- **Clearer errors.** *CAOMS is not defined*, *Unknown request [NOT_FOUND]* and the out-of-date banner now say what to do.
- **Documentation.** Setup guide rewritten (shared code and own copy), error codes extended, this user guide updated for backups, updates and speed.
- Techmin console now also lists users of the new **CMA Report Maker** tool.

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First release of CA Office Manager, a work, client, time, fee and compliance management system for chartered accountancy firms.

Your data stays with your firm. Each firm sets up its own private workspace in its own Google account (Google Sheets for data, Drive for documents, Gmail for email). The page hosted at `tools.complypro.co.in/ca-office-manager/` only displays the data; it has no database of its own, and Techmin does not receive, host or have access to any firm's records. Techmin keeps only a register of the firms that use the software (see *Firm register and notices*).

Status: under testing. The application code passed 204 automated backend tests and 82 browser tests against a simulated Google environment. Behaviour that depends on Google itself (real Drive, Gmail sending, scheduled triggers) has not yet been verified on a live account. See *Known limitations*.

What is included

- **Clients**: master records with PAN, GSTIN, TAN checks, contacts, services by financial year, pipeline stages, CSV import with dry run and CSV export, masked identifiers.
- **Tasks**: templates, allocation with workload warnings, acknowledgement, instructions with version history, checklists with mandatory items, dependencies, senior and partner review with correction rounds, bulk create, bulk reassign and bulk due-date change, recurring tasks, full task history.
- **Time and leave**: running timer with pause and resume, manual entries, correction requests and approvals, attendance check-in and check-out, leave requests, approvals and balances, productivity and unallocated-time views.
- **Compliance calendar**: due dates entered and verified by the firm, per-client filings, acknowledgement numbers, tasks created from filings, reminders.
- **Fees and receipts**: fee agreements, draft and issued invoices with server-side tax, receipts and allocations, credit notes, write-offs, cancellations with reasons, follow-up register, ageing, outstanding and statements.
- **Physical files**: inward entry, transfers with acknowledgement, outside parties with expected return dates, return, archive, lost-file exceptions, overdue reminders.
- **Documents**: Drive folders per client, versioning, three confidentiality classes, document requests with checklists, every download logged, no public links.
- **Client email**: templates, drafts, approval by senior or partner, safe sending with duplicate protection, delivery log and quota check.

- **Reports**: 25 reports with CSV export and print.
- **Administration**: users, roles and permissions (grant or deny per person), settings, masters and templates, audit log, backups, CSV export, document inventory, configuration export, backup verification and scheduled jobs.
- **Alerts and announcements** on the dashboard and in the top bar.

New in this release

- **One workspace per firm, in the firm's own Google account.** A partner sets up the workspace in about 20 minutes by following the *Firm setup guide* (also under **Help → Firm setup** and at `setup.html`). The firm's records, documents and sent email then belong to the firm's Google account only.
- **Connect screen and firm link.** The hosted page asks which workspace to open. The firm gives staff a *firm link* (shown in Administration → Settings and printed in every activation email); opening it and pressing **Connect** is enough. The workspace is remembered in the browser and can be changed from the sign-in card. Only genuine Google script addresses are accepted, and a link always needs a deliberate click on **Connect**.
- **Activation key by email.** When someone registers, the firm's own system emails the key to them immediately. The key is stored only as a hash, expires in 3 days and works once. The sign-in cards now explain where the key comes from for each kind of user (self-registered, added by the administrator, or the partner who set up the workspace).
- **First administrator key emailed at setup.** Setup sends the administrator key to the Google account used for setup and also prints it in the execution log.
- **Administrator approval** (on by default) before a self-registered person can sign in, with an approval email and a *Pending approval* badge and **Approve** button under Users.
- **Abuse protection** for registration: hidden spam field, a limit of 3 requests per email and 40 in total per hour, and identical replies for known and unknown emails.
- **Optional other sender address.** Emails come from the firm's own Google account by default. A firm may add its own alias under Gmail *Send mail as* and enter it as `mail_from`; if Gmail refuses the alias the account's own address is used with Reply-To set.
- **Demonstration workspace.** A clearly marked workspace with fictional data for looking around; never for real client information.
- **Firm register and notices (new).** After the first sign-in the firm administrator completes a one-time form, *Register your firm with Techmin*: firm name, address, city, state, pincode, PAN, GSTIN (optional), ICAI registration number (optional), contact person, email and mobile, with a consent statement. Techmin then knows which firms use the software, since when, where they are, and how to reach them. Techmin also receives the software version, the number of active users and the last-used date; it never receives clients, tasks, documents, fees, invoices, staff records or emails. A PAN can be registered once, and the firm's key is stored by Techmin only as a hash.
- **Notices and payment reminders from Techmin (new).** Techmin can send update, maintenance and payment notices to all firms, selected firms, or firms with a given payment status, optionally also by email. They appear as a coloured strip above every screen and under *Administration → Techmin account*, which also shows plan, payment status, paid-until date and amount due. If Techmin is unreachable the application keeps working.
- **Firm link card with Copy buttons (new).** *Administration → Settings* shows the exact firm link and the workspace address, each with a Copy button.
- **Messages (new).** Two-way internal messages between partners, administrators and staff, to named people or whole groups, with replies in the same conversation, an *urgent* flag, an unread count in the menu, alerts, and read receipts (*Read by name, date and time*) shown to the sender. Sending and reading are written to the audit log (without the message text); only the people in a conversation can read it. Existing workspaces get the two new tabs when `migrateSchema` is run during the update.
- **Leave approval made easy to find.** Waiting leave requests appear in the Alerts list, as a dashboard card for approvers and in *Time & leave → Leave* under *Waiting for your approval*. When applying, a box shows who will decide the request. Leave applied for by a firm administrator goes to another approver (never to themselves); if the firm has no other approver it is recorded as approved automatically.

- **Techmin console (new, for Techmin staff).** A protected web page where Techmin sees every firm using the software (name, since when, city and state, address, GSTIN, PAN, contact, status, payment, version, users, last seen), searches and downloads the list, updates a firm's status and payment details, and sends notices to all firms, selected firms or firms with a given payment status (payment reminders), optionally also by email. Withdrawn notices disappear from firms' screens. Access needs a console key emailed to the Techmin account; only its hash is stored. See *Techmin registry and console guide*.
- **Faster saving.** Changes made in one action are written to Google Sheets together instead of row by row, sheet lookups are reused within a request, and registering the firm now takes three server calls instead of five.
- **Fewer round trips.** Signing in now fetches your profile, notifications, registration status and the dashboard in one request instead of several, and list and report screens you just opened are kept for 20 seconds so moving between screens is instant (any change clears them). Older workspace code still works, just without this speed-up.
- **Automatic updates through shared code.** A firm's project is now a small connector to a shared Techmin library, so a new version reaches every firm without anyone pasting code. Firms that prefer their own copy can still use it. The page shows an *out of date* notice when a workspace is behind, and *Unknown request* errors now explain what to do.
- **Mandatory automatic backup, JSON download and restore.** The firm administrator chooses the backup day; backups cannot be switched off, repair their own trigger, alert administrators when missed, and now also save a JSON file. Administrators can download a JSON backup at any time and restore from it with a typed confirmation and an automatic safety copy.
- **Automatic upgrade of the database.** After new code is deployed, the first sign-in adds new tabs, columns and settings; running `migrateSchema` by hand is no longer needed.
- **Much quicker response.** The audit log is no longer read in full for every save (it grows every day, so saving used to get slower over time). Users and Settings are kept in a short-lived cache, sign-in asks for the firm registration at the same time as your profile, and a thin blue bar at the top of the page shows whenever the page is waiting for the server. To get this in your own workspace, paste the new `Code_all.gs` over `Code.gs` and deploy a new version.
- **Step-by-step setup guide (new).** The setup page now shows one step at a time (13 steps) with exactly what to do, where to do it, where to paste each file, what you should see and when you are done; progress is remembered in the browser.
- **Techmin registry guide (new)** for Techmin staff: deploying the registry, reading the firm list, recording payments and sending notices.
- **Help inside the application**: the detailed user guide for every screen, the error-code reference, the firm setup guide and these release notes, from **Help** in the left menu.
- **Error codes** are shown at the end of every error message, for example *[AUTH]*, *[FORBIDDEN]* or *[VALIDATION]*.
- Settings `open_registration`, `registration_approval`, `registration_default_role`, `mail_from`, `mail_from_name`, `app_url`.

Security and privacy

- Passwords are salted and hashed; activation keys and sessions are never stored in readable form.
- Five wrong passwords lock the account for 15 minutes; sessions end after about 6 hours.
- Permissions are checked by the server on every action; the menu only hides what you may not use.
- Sensitive client identifiers are masked unless the person holds the specific permission.
- Documents stay private in Drive; each download is logged; Restricted documents open only for the client's partner, the uploader and top management.
- Every change is written to an audit log that cannot be edited.
- The page sets no cookies and loads no advertising or third-party scripts; it keeps only your session and screen filters in the browser tab's session storage.

Requirements

- A current browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari) with JavaScript enabled.
- A Google account for the firm that owns the Apps Script project, the database sheet and the Drive folders (a dedicated firm account is recommended so access survives staff changes).
- An internet connection that can reach Techmin's registry for registration and notices (the application keeps working without it).
- Optional: another sender address added under Gmail → Settings → Accounts → *Send mail as* on the owner account.

Known limitations

- Sign-in is the application's own email-and-password system, with no two-factor step.
- One Google account per firm owns all of that firm's data; keep backups outside it and add a second owner.
- The page code is published by Techmin, so page updates come from Techmin. Firms that want full control can host the page files themselves.
- Each firm must complete the one-time workspace setup before its staff can use the application.
- Google Sheets is not a transactional database; very large firms should plan archiving (see Limitations and quotas).
- Gmail limits apply: about 100 emails a day on a free account and 1,500 on Workspace.
- Statutory due dates and rates are not built in; the administrator enters and verifies them. The application does not compute GST, TDS or income tax returns and does not file on any government portal.
- Integrations with government portals, e-signature, WhatsApp, SMS and payment gateways are not connected.
- No offline mode; screens refresh when you move between them and alerts update about every 2 minutes.
- Drive files are not scanned for viruses; only type and size are checked.

Not yet verified on the live account

Real Drive upload and download, real Gmail sending and quota, the scheduled daily and weekly jobs, concurrent writes from several users, backup restore, and layout on real phones. Procedures are in the test report.

Upgrading

Changes to the page go live as soon as the new file is published on GitHub Pages (refresh with Ctrl+F5). Each firm updates its own Apps Script code by pasting the new `Code_all.gs` and choosing *Deploy → Manage deployments → Edit → New version*; the workspace address does not change. The database is not changed by an upgrade; the setup routine adds any missing tabs and settings and keeps existing data.

Support

Quote the **error code**, the **full message** and, for SERVER errors, the **reference**. Administrators find the reference in the Apps Script *Executions* log.